

PUNE | Lots of Space



Could this be the answer to urban India's parking problems? TAL Manufacturing Solutions, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Tata Motors, has created TAL-Vertipark, a first-of-its-kind fully automatic multi-level vertical stand-alone car parking system. Maximising parking area for vehicles of all shapes and sizes, the total ground space occupied is that of three vehicles. Like cars, TAL-Vertipark also comes in two variants—a 20-level module for up to 40 vehicles and a 10-level module for up to 20 vehicles. Vertipark has been developed on an original design from MP Systems Co Ltd Korea, under a licence agreement. *by Nivedita Mukherjee*

LUCKNOW | Voted Out

Youth voting patterns in the Lok Sabha have now produced a new theme song for Muslim leaders. Last week in Mumbai, Deputy Chairperson of the Rajya Sabha K. Rahman Khan declared: "Leaders who win and become legislators are responsible for the woes of the Muslim community in India." Young India it seems is on to that, ruthlessly voting against Muslim MPs in the last few elections. The numbers of Muslim MPs fell from an all-time high of 48 in 1980 to 29 in 2009. Stalwarts were cast off like dry leaves in the Lok Sabha polls this year, but the community didn't shed a tear. One Urdu daily in fact said: "For the last 60 years, Muslim leaders who went to Parliament or assemblies showed more interest in serving their own purposes."

by Farzand Ahmed

TO PLUG THE GAPS IN ITS RADAR COVERAGE OVER INDIA, THE AIR FORCE HAS SIGNED A DEAL TO BUY 30 3-D RADARS.

DELHI | Safer Skies

The Indian Air Force has gone in for a massive purchase of 3-D medium-range surveillance radars to plug the gaps in its radar coverage over India, particularly from low-flying aircraft. It is buying 30 Rohini 3D radars worth Rs 2,001 crore and Low Level Transportable Radars (LLTR) worth Rs 699.54 crore from the PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd. The LLTRs have a range of 150 km and can detect low-flying aircraft and UAVs. The indigenously developed truck-mounted medium-range Rohini has a 150-km range and can track multiple targets at up to 55,000 ft. *by Sandeep Unnithan*

A BOOK ABOUT CHARANDAS CHOR IS BANNED FOR A FLIMSY REASON.

RAIPUR | Fouled Play

The Chhattisgarh Government's ban on a book around late theatre personality Habib Tanvir's iconic play *Charandas Chor* has created a furor in the theatre community. The book first created a flutter in Chhattisgarh in 2004 as Tanvir had made some references to Guru Ghasidas, an 18th century spiritual figure, in the preface. It did not go down well with the state's Dalit Satnami community. "The play can't be staged with adverse comments against Guru Ghasidas," says state Culture and School Education Minister Brijmohan Agarwal. The irony is that the play doesn't even mention the Guru, only the preface of the book about it does. *by Ambresh Mishra*



TANVIR IN THE PLAY

BANDEEP SINGH